Note to the reader:

This book is better read in random order, which is the way it has been written. The author and the publisher suggest that you rip off all the pages*, pile them up, and then throw them in the air just like you just don't care. Once all pages have been properly shuffled, you are ready to start.

* The Publisher also recommends extreme attention when handling scissors, knives or other cutting equipment and states that it assumes no responsibility for improper use of this book.

LANAIL HUDSON
IMITATION OF LIFE

SECOND EDITION

Notes and analysis by Leroy Meyers

"Charades, pop skill,
Water hyacinth,
Named by a poet."

Seven songs slammed on a crackling AM radio on the road[1]

Seven songs slammed on a crackling AM radio on the road
an awful, terrible road, its end I cannot see
Endless fall

Dropped phone-calls from work; I'm not in -
stringed and tied to the most awful road.
We are the difference between jealousy and reason.

[I am not a liberator. Liberators do not exist. The people liberate themselves] [2]

And you don't seem to understand what could be happening
We are the difference between failure and the idea of failing
I keep saying to myself

that

I want to be

All for you -

But I cannot unsee.

[if there is no struggle there is no progress]

Across the frozen wasteland in the bitter cold
I freeze
And I burn in the hazy sectors of
words I almost read and I cannot unsee

on the road
I cannot see
and I will not leave

drawn

drugs

[ideas are also weapons]

Last sentence of an actor:
reaffirming her intentions,
In a cold British august, an eighty-seven year old
asked why, oh why wasn't he there.

She sounded scared.
her miscounted misfortune,
the obtained garbage, shaved off.

Leftovers of mortal remains.

[1] First of all I would like to say that nobody, in this god blessed, civilized green planet, listens to AM radio any longer. I know for a fact that Lanail Hudson hated AM radio in its complete entirety. Three months after publishing his fourth collection of essays *I'd talk to myself more often but I can't book an appointment*, he and I were sitting in the college cafe, trying to find out why the peas on Thursday are always more difficult to digest, when he looked at me with puzzled eyes. For those who met him, you know what I'm talking about. Lanail would have talked and listened to you for hours, until, sometimes, something you said triggered a train of thought inside of him, and off he went, on a think-tank tangent, not even he knew where it would it bring him. That morning, I'm sorry I can't be precise on the day - after all my memory is not as good as it was years ago (one more reason to put down on paper as much as possible before it's too late) - during our discussion about mushy peas, Lanail froze. I mean, he stood still like he just had a vision, as if the Holy Virgin Mary appeared right before his eyes, sitting where I was, holding a spoonful of half eaten fish and chips in midair. I asked him what was wrong. No reply. I'm not sure I need to actually spell it out, after all if you are reading this book you know who the character was and how he would behave in public (a clear example I'm sure everyone is thinking of, was the infamous interview for the German television and the subsequent ban from their public broadcasting).

Anyway, he stood there like a block of ice.

"Hey. Lanail. What's the matter?" I asked again.

He met my eyes, and, deadly serious, replied, "Have you ever considered AM radio? I mean, who listens to it anyway?"

"Excuse me?" I said. Lanail used to have a lot of non-sequitur thoughts, and this was most certainly one of the most random that he ever dropped on me.

"You know" he explained "AM radio is for peasants. For those villagers stuck in a farm in the middle of nowhere who spend their time complaining that the British drive on the wrong side of the road - and Australians and Japanese, but they surely don't count - and listening to AM radio broadcasting like it was the biggest breakthrough in the history of human technological advancement."

"I'm not sure I'm following you."

He stood up, grabbed his notepad and his brown shoulder bag, and left me there in the cafeteria, mid-lunch and mid-sentence. That was Lanail.

[2] Obviously back in the day you could get away with this kind of thing. Who would have gone all the way down the path of unraveling hidden quotes (or, as he liked to call them, "homages")? Well, I did, and *surprise surprise*, what we see in square brackets are not the guilty fruits of the poetic mind of Lanail Hudson, but, in fact, quotes he stole from Che Guevara and the Sub-Comandante Marcos. Lanail was probably trying to show off his in-depth knowledge of communist related topics, or perhaps he was trying to fool people into thinking he was much smarter, brighter, and more knowledgeable than what he was.

A fun fact. Lanail and I flown to Los Angeles to present his third collection, *Men with upside-down hats*. This was three years before *The Night of the Servant*, so nobody really knew us. Since we had a few hours to spare before we met his agent, we strolled around town and went for a coffee at a Whole Foods Market. It was a nice, bright, sunny afternoon, though one kid who worked there, a boy no older than 19, probably didn't enjoy that day very much.

A woman walked up to him.

"Excuse me, my dear, where can I find your foie gras?" She asked.

"Our what?" He was looking at her like she was some sort of alien asking for Martian delicatessen.

"Foie gras." She repeated.

"I'm not sure I understand, madam".

"It's- it's goose liver. Duck pate."

There is a video of an actor, Aaron Paul. He became famous for playing the character Jessie in the TV-series Breaking Bad. Before he was famous, he participated in an episode of *The Price is Right*. When the voice off-camera announced his name, he started jumping and shouting, as though he had just won the lottery. Well, this is, with no hyperboles, exactly what that kid did that day, when he finally understood what that lady was talking about.

"I thought it was pronounced fou-ton!" He stated, to then stride with the lady to an aisle out of our sight.

We were a couple of meters away from them, so we witnessed the whole conversation.

Apparently, the association between foie gras and a futon was too much to Lanail. He stood up and ran to the till.

I followed him. "Where are you going?" I asked. No reply.

"I demand to talk to a manager", he told the cashier.

A manager arrived.

"What can I do for you?"

"I'm Doctor Kal Lonera, addiction specialist", said Lanail "I need to report one of your employees. He shows clear symptoms of marijuana use, and I will report you and your store to your head office, and that boy to the police, if no special measures will be taken."

Now, I'm not going to give you all the details of what happened next, but from that point Lanail went on a long rant, making up studies and waving several times the words "employer liability", "media scandal" and "drug abuse cover up" at the poor manager, who ultimately called the boy over, who, pressed by Lanail's grave tone, not surprisingly admitted he smoked weed every now and then.

We arrived at the book presentation 3 hours late, Lanail's agent was furious, and, believe it or not, the boy actually lost his job that day.

Back to the hotel that night, I asked him how did he know about the weed.

"I didn't." he said. "I simply didn't like the word *futon*."

[3] We had a conversation, once.

"Ecofeminism is the way to go. You know how capitalism defied the natural world as simply a body of resources to be exploited and reshaped to serve human purposes and interests. I like their idea of seeing capitalism as inherently sapping the relationship between humans to one another and to the natural world. It is unarguable that capitalism is a patriarchal construction based on the colonization of women, nature, and other people." He said.

"I would agree all the way through, if I hadn't such a clear vision of the new personal computer you bought."

"Though it is true that we need to build a system that uses participatory decision making as an economic mechanism to guide the production, consumption and allocation of resources in a given society, and that some form of participatory economics and inclusive democracy will be necessary in the new millennium, it is also true that *Alone in the Dark* is an excellent video game, and that the only way to play it is through a machine that runs MS-DOS and Windows 95.

If it makes you feel better, I always curse Microsoft while I wait for the game to load."

Empty hallways past midnight[4]

empty hallways past midnight
your steps like a herd of marching elephants
up the stairs through the corridor
outside my door –
we are clouds.
clouds.
clouds.

empty hallways past midnight
an instrumental post rock song, you and I.
I'd lose myself in you
all night,
squinting my eyes to see you better
to hear you better –
we are clouds.
clouds in a storm.

empty hallways past midnight
so very empty.
I rewind my Walkman and drown
in a deafening tune
now that I have no more you to listen to -
we were clouds
clouds in a storm,
and it rained.[5]

[4] "What the hell are you doing?"

Lanail's office was a mess. There were boxes everywhere. All of his books were scattered on the floor. The room looked like it had been hit by an earthquake.

He looked like he slept in his office. He was wearing the same clothes as the previous day, and he hadn't shaved. To be honest, it's not like he looked much different from any other day. His hair looked terrible as usual.

The previous day we had tacos for lunch. A taco (as tacos commonly do) exploded like a landmine over Lanail's shirt. He probably squeezed it too hard and the juice squirted all over him. Anyway, this is not important. He was wearing the same shirt he wore the previous day, and this is pretty much everything you need to know. The shirt was simply a coincidence, and wearing something that made him look like a potential murderer was just minor detail. But I digress again.

"Emma kicked me out. I slept in the office."

I am aware most people would have replied with a sympathetic "Oh my goodness! Are you ok?" or "Oh, my friend! I'm so sorry!" or "Oh, pal! This is such a tragedy!" but firstly, I wouldn't use the word "pal" even if my life depended on it; secondly, I didn't care much about the answer; and last but not least, my main concern was something completely different.

"How the hell did you pass through security?" I asked him.

"I had to pretend I was using the library and then I hid in the office at closing time. I couldn't use the toilet and I slept on the desk, then I moved onto the chair." He points at two water bottles filled with urine. "I had to pee in bottles."

"Your office looks like an Israeli bus after a suicide bomber visited it."

"Since I was here, I decided to do some research on the correlation between capitalism and post colonialist industrial globalization. My conclusion is that we need to reform the so-called democratic system from the outside. We need to mobilize the masses, Leroy."

"Lanail, why did Emma kick you out?"

"Have you ever heard of Twitter?"

"I don't live under a rock." I replied.

"I have just discovered it. It's like MySpace, but with people in. We can use it to impeach the government."

I had no idea what he was talking about.

"It sounds groundbreaking."

"Don't be sarcastic, Leroy."

"What does all of this even have to do with Emma kicking you out?"

"Emma is not the problem. Or perhaps, she is, as I don't have a place to sleep tonight. You have a sofa bed, right? Can I crash on it for a couple of nights? Also, do you have a clean shirt that I can borrow? Mine makes me looks like I killed an infant. Also, we need to contact the New Yorker. They might be interested in my manifesto."

By that point, my confusion had evolved into an infinite vortex of unwired rambling. It used to happen more often than I wished.

"I believe you're skipping some steps. And no, I don't have a spare shirt." I replied.

"I'll explain while we drive to a clothes shop. I would not mind a clean shirt. Let's go."

"What happened with Emma, Lanail?"

"She may or may not have come back home earlier and found me snorting coke off the belly of a hooker on acid, in our bed."

"Jesus H. Christ, Lanail."

"Emma is not the problem now. Putting a clean shirt on is the problem, remember? Then the government. Then the hooker – or Emma. I don't know what I'm going to tackle first, I haven't figured it out just yet."

[5] Why is this story interesting? Because this is what really started it all. A hooker on acid with cocaine on her belly.

Though Lanail loved to play the hero, he had been deeply affected by the split up. Emma had a strong will, and for a good number of years she somehow handled him well enough to make him behave like a proper human being. Then, this happened.

Lanail moved into a motel after the breakdown, and became progressively obsessed with the government and with the use of political intervention in a citizen's life. I tried to dissuade him. I wanted him to get a less paranoid hobby, like bowling, or golf, or collecting stamps. Defending my point became much more difficult after he became so popular on the Internet.

On another side note, Lanail was just trying to be cool when he wrote about rewinding his Walkman. He had an iPod, like all regular human beings. I mean, he wrote this poem in 2011, who the hell was still using cassette tapes then?

Furthermore, this poem has close resemblance with the song *Killing Clouds* by *Flipped Over Penguins*. It also sort of steals the mood from the chorus of *Africa* by the 80's band *Toto*.

You will probably notice how close the meaning is “I’d lose myself in you / squinting my eyes to see you better / we are clouds.” with “It's gonna take a lot to drag me away from you / I bless the rains down in Africa / Gonna take some time to do the things we never had.” It is absurd that nobody else ever seemed to have noticed it.


REVOLUCION!
NO POLITICS NO RULES NO LAWS
NO LANDLORDS NO BOSSES
People of the Internet, RISE!

6

[6] A couple of hours later, Lanail, in front of my office door, waved this leaflet at me.

"I just created it." He said. "I made one with crayons, but I thought it was too childish. No one would want to join a childish revolution."

"Come on in." I replied.

This is how the revolution started.

"We're going to create a protest movement. We will reunite artists and intellectuals, writers and singers, painters, philosophers and workers. A lot of workers."

"You're forming a political party?"

"No no no! Far from it! We're going to create knowledge. We will educate people. We'll substitute the official governmental educational system with our own. We'll form a parallel, free alternative to the bullshit we're told every day. We'll put artists and workers together and we're going to make a revolution."

the tingling sound of a coin in a well.

The sense of profound emptiness,
a conversation with you.
The tragically resembling sound
of… you know those jars
you blow into - and they make
a grave hollow sound?
It is. That.[7]

[7] There is a thin red line between revolutionaries and con artists. In spite of what everyone thinks, Lanail was, in my opinion, a con artist (nonetheless, an *artist*).

Whenever I listen to Goran Bregovic, or any other Balkan music for that matter, I can never identify the author. Before Bregovic sues me, I'm not saying he plagiarized his music. I'm saying I can't distinguish his songs from any other artists from the same area. Whether that music is Yugoslavian, Bulgarian or Russian, is completely beyond me. Where is Bregovic from, anyway?

Anyhow, that was not my point. Binjamin Wilkomirski, for example. Let's analyse him. That guy wrote a great book and nobody reads it nowadays, which is a shame for many reasons. Or Margaret Selzer.

There is a difference between what is said, what is shown, and the reality of the facts, and all I'm saying is that Lanail loved deceiving people. He loved to throw little hints of alleged truth at you. Small pieces of an always-incomplete puzzle, impossible to solve, as you were never shown the complete picture. Several pieces were purposely missing, some others completely fabricated, and others were in reality parts of other puzzles. When I write this kind of stuff it seems like I'm diminishing it, and I'm genuinely not. I appreciate Lanail's work and I know it well – there must be a reason if a publisher contacts you and asks you to write a critical analysis of the works of such a famous writer. I mean, this isn't some trashy crap like *I'm the secret son of John Lennon*, the fake memoir written by Jonathan R. Terwilliger. That guy is a joke. I don't even know how he got a publishing contract in the first place.

Does knowing his sources diminish the artistic quality of his works?

Yes.

When you're at Disneyland, Mickey Mouse is cool because you only see the character and not the immigrant that's paid $4 per hour to sweat inside a mascot costume. I don't even want to see it. Why would I want to see a sweaty Mexican dude? When you look behind the scenes, the scene itself loses power. You see it's only a trick. You see the reality of the actors before they become characters; you see Peter Pan flying while attached to a cable. Magic tricks are nice until you switch angles and see their sleight of hand.

Lanail Hudson was a revolutionary prestidigitator. His words, a legerdemain.

No hay banda.

Midnight in the City of Destruction

The groaned sound of a typewriter from
another room is an orange jail covered
by a blanket of shadows.
My hopes, in a hotel room,
collapsed unfairly.

Cold air as a buzzing light, intermittently
reminds me of the existence of a falling
ring of smoke -
cries of anarchy and revolutionary socialism.

Nothing besides remains.
Thoughts come undone
this evening -

decisions
plans

alone.

A newscaster blathers
about dead people hundreds of miles away
Not here.
It's a bitter advent,
A call for the fall of fallen leaves
and men's dreams
I Sing *alone*g

The same day I value a moment
"Now it's good." I declare
Calling dibs on fizzy cola candies
walking back to the hotel
with a new mandolin.

I can't play mandolin (just yet).

The shadows of lost homes -
Lost houses in Palestine.

Got himself killed, the bastard.
The same mellow voice
of the endlessly talking anchorman
that makes me think I've had enough
of TVs n' dead bodies n' bad news
I was standing at the crossroad
waiting for instructions
I would never receive,
and it's time to leave
this hotel room again.

Missing decision
(missing reel)

There is a secret prison.[8]
In that secret prison
there is a secret service
And uh… prisoners bound and
gathered landed and beaten -
secret prisons
cease secret wars.

Ten out of ten
for one night
It's enough. [9]

I'm the new man
I'm the new city

Sun, rises over the Roseland
I strode back to hotel
Left my shoes in the bathroom
And went to bed,
this time,
I left my TV off. [10]

[8]…away from all social duties, and bon ton, and responsibilities, and manners, like "We can't have lunch now, sweetie, it's only quarter past eleven" or "Please pull your trousers up, sir, this is a post office, not a swimming pool" or "Sir, I'm going to have to call the security if you don't stop drawing genitalia on that whiteboard."

Because this is really what society forces you to do.

[9] Enough what?

[10] People always seemed to like the fragmented poetic style of Hudson. I, personally, never did. He and I have been good friends and have always respected each other, and I never made a mystery of my opinions on it. This fact never bothered him too much, I believe. "Your poems really suck." I told him once. If my memory is not betraying me, it was at some retirement party we had been forced to attend, the fella's name I'm not sure of. "You believe you could trick your audience into thinking you're smart simply because they don't understand a single word you say."

"I've tricked many people then." He proceeded to pull out a notebook from his jacket; he opened it, scrolled through some pages, and handed it in to me. It was the first draft of *Midnight in the City of Destruction.*

"I'm not sure I get it." I admitted.

"The inference is that the man put on paper is a free man, he's *de facto* a free man. As I represent freedom, or better, the development of the inner motivations that makes a man crave freedom, each and every attitude or social behavior becomes relevant, as every moment could potentially deliver the whole human kind a different outcome."

"You are talking about the butterfly effect."

"Yes. And no. We don't have the instruments to predict how our behavior will affect other people's lives; therefore not choosing becomes the only plausible choice. It's one of the many contradictions of a capitalist society that wants you to believe that your role is important for the sake of the economy while leaving you on a dead-end, repetitive job for 50 hours a week. It's what makes men marionettes played by superior external forces. Everybody thinks life is a tragedy, when it is, in fact, vaudeville."

How could I have argued with such an argument?

the clash.

We arrived at the square in the early morning. People were gathering with the same calm slow pace a torrent in summertime uses as it strides through woods and valleys uncaring of the world around it. We arrived and it smelled of urine, sweat, fear, rage. It smelled of that peculiar sense of community and closeness to people that only ever so seldom happens. A man with a megaphone walked in front of everybody, yelled slogans. That man was me. We stood still, police there, us here.
Barking blood thirsty dogs on the other side, violent servant of a power that moves them around like marionettes - paper planes in a hurricane, ready to drop bombs on those they are duly sworn to protect.

Silence. Slogans.

We march peacefully, noiseless as electrons around atoms. Protons disagree. They charge us. Spartans running against Ghandi and all I see is blood. It covers my eyes. I fall, an arm picks me up. I clear my face and my sleeves turn crimson. Ferrous taste in my mouth. I turn around to see barking Dogs biting at Victims of Justice. Blood on my cheek, not mine, not my own. I see the U N I O N of people dissolved by the raging tear of government. Unified, we become divided by violence.[11]

[11] Writing experimental fiction has the same artistic sickness of giving a literary critic a blowjob while he sucks your cock. It's art that spins around art and talks to no one, if not the "artist" himself. Lanail used to take pride in his inaccessible prose and the cryptic poetry. He loved being bashed by the public to whom he claimed to speak, and consider everyone an ignorant servant of the traditional narrative. A weird, cringing contrast, contemplating the development of only a few years later, when Lanail discovered his revolutionary inner self and, as we saw, decided to turn the masses against the established power and aimed to create a new social ~~dis~~order.

Experimental fiction was – and still is – so divorced from real life that it creates an alienating experience, an endless game of hide-and-seek between the reader, scanning the neighborhood around him to find the writer, and the writer, who in the meantime, has driven to the airport, bought a ticket, boarded a plane and now he's sipping whiskey and flirting with an air hostess on his way to a different continent.

How Lanail's novel *The Night of the Servant* managed to become so successful is beyond me. I remember reading the third draft and thinking "Man, how am I going to tell him this novel is utterly, rubbishly, appallingly shit without hurting his feelings?"

I wrote my notes, saying that the character of Lisa Paris was unimaginably bad. An empty archetype of a wannabe pretentious intellectual with a very limited view of the artistic world around her. He took my advice only partially and changed her last name to *Ciderville* to give her a more international flavor. In spite of my skepticism (and what I perceived as a very arrogant lack of changes, in my humble opinion), the book was an unexpected success. Critics went wild with praise and the public seemed to love every single word in it. The *Night of the Servant* debuted at number one pretty much everywhere. Lanail took all his remaining holidays to release interviews, go to various book signings and shake fans' hands. His agent, Sarah Fisher, was just as surprised as everybody else. When Lanail called her to tell her he had just been on Amazon and saw that the book was on the top of the chart, her reaction was "Well . . . I would guess it's a . . . good thing, right?"

Seven days later, Warner Bros. contacted Lanail through Sarah to offer a contract to make *The Night of the Servant* a blockbuster movie. They said they were ready to offer a shitload of money and they wanted to give Nicholas Cage the leading role. Thank goodness Lanail refused. I have strong feelings against Cage, and if by any chance the movie had been shot, I'm pretty sure I would have had to go to the premier and perhaps meet him too. I wasn't looking forward to it. On a side note, I just remembered when I tweeted him saying that his

acting in *National Treasure: Book of Secrets* was so bad I almost died of dysentery and he called me an asshole and said that I should be banned from Twitter.
Anyway, that's not the point. The point is that Lanail became massively famous overnight and copious amounts of money started flowing in.

Circumstances, capacities, desires and aspirations.

The division of labor, as a process in which the activities necessary for the society to live and develops roles, it's necessary to grow and reproduce. The problem arises when specialized labor becomes expert of a role, therefore adding rules and limitations to their own views.

Intelligence as an innate concept and/or a socially structured proposition brings nothing but social disorder that we need to eliminate. Industrial capitalistic ruling class has used these tools to hold the power, using rules as a whip, to submit and punish the free will of those who disagree, or that threaten the power of the ruling class. Slavery has been justified and accepted for a good couple of millennia. Society imposed a superior power over the slaves' heads, showing off all the reasons why it is fair that a human being rightfully owns another one. And nobody protested, because the reasons were there for everyone to read – or at least for those who knew how. Yet here we are, two centuries later, debating how cruel such practices were, and how inhuman, and how embarrassing for our ancestors – whether they were on one side or another of the whip.

The same happens today to me, you, and everyone you know. A haggard minority controls war, peace, economy, social care, and mostly knowledge. They decide who has the right to be cured in a hospital, who will be blessed with a passport (the modern equivalent of cattle branding), they decide who pays taxes, and in what quantity. All of this while getting rich in the process, controlling the flux of information available to the general public, trying their best to keep the population uninformed, ignorant and divided. Creating social structures privileges a few and at the same time creates enemies. "They are privileged" they'll teach you, "You should hate them," they will tell you "You should despise your siblings and neighbors", they'll preach while reaching minorities to arouse them "You're better than them" they'll say, "See how bestially hateful those ignorant goats are?" they'll say, "You should use your privileges to make sure WE stay where we are, it's the only solution. It's the only way out. It's the only way to keep the privileges you have worked so hard for."[12]

[12] I really have nothing to say about it, except that I disagree with it and that I suspect most of the piece has been stolen verbatim from Noam Chomsky's *Rogue State*. How Lanail got away with it is completely beyond my comprehension.

Watching a poetry contest

Unlimited refill
of flat coke.[13]

[13] Sarah Fisher, Lanail's agent, insisted that he finally took his writing career seriously – or at least, *more* seriously – and quit his academic career to promote the book first and work on a new title later. Though he wasn't particularly excited by the idea of starting a new book straight away, the curse of having to wake up early in the morning to talk about John Milton to perpetually aroused teenagers was definitely an attractive offer. Lanail's night time drugs habit would have surely been happy with it.

So he agreed – sort of. He took two years unpaid leave and signed the new book contract. Without me knowing it, he put a clause in the contract stating that he and I came in a bundled package. If they wanted him they had to take me too, as his PA, or copy editor, or god knows what else. Sarah insisted she could provide him more professional collaborators. Lanail replied that it was either both of us, or none of us. They agreed.

"You're quitting your job." he told me. He went on explaining that not only would I have earned enough money to survive – guaranteed money! – but that I would also have possibly earned more – which wasn't very difficult, teaching literature.

"You're not actually *quitting* your job" he specified. "You're taking two years unpaid leave, as I'm doing, and you'll decide what to do with your life in 24 months time."

"Sarah is right, you know? You could have your work edited by more competent people. Why me?"

"Because you don't hold your insults when I need them."

"Lanail, you *never* follow my suggestions."

"I'm aware of that. That's one other reason." I guessed that sentence was his sick, contorted way of calling me a friend, and I didn't mind.

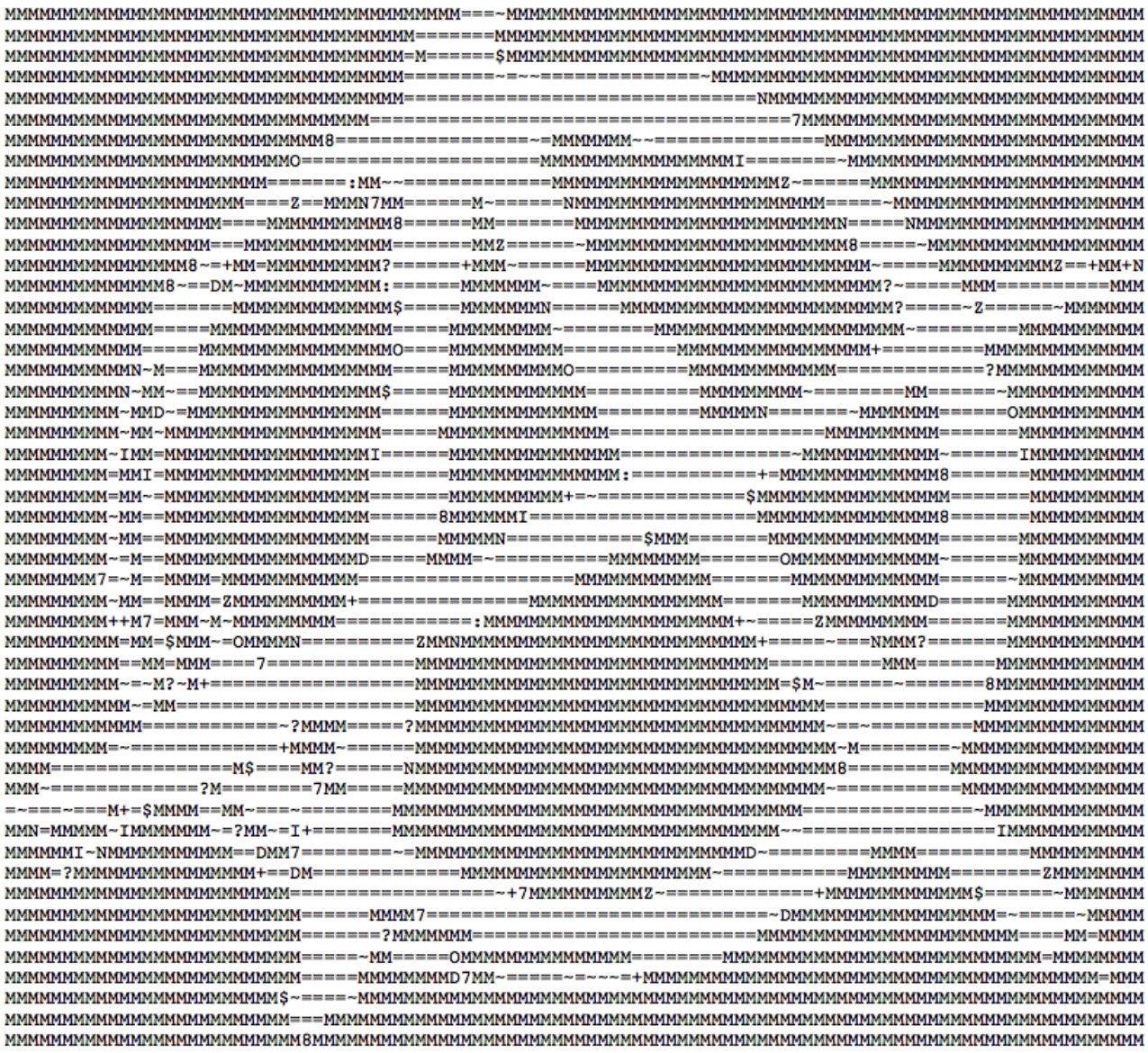
I shrugged.

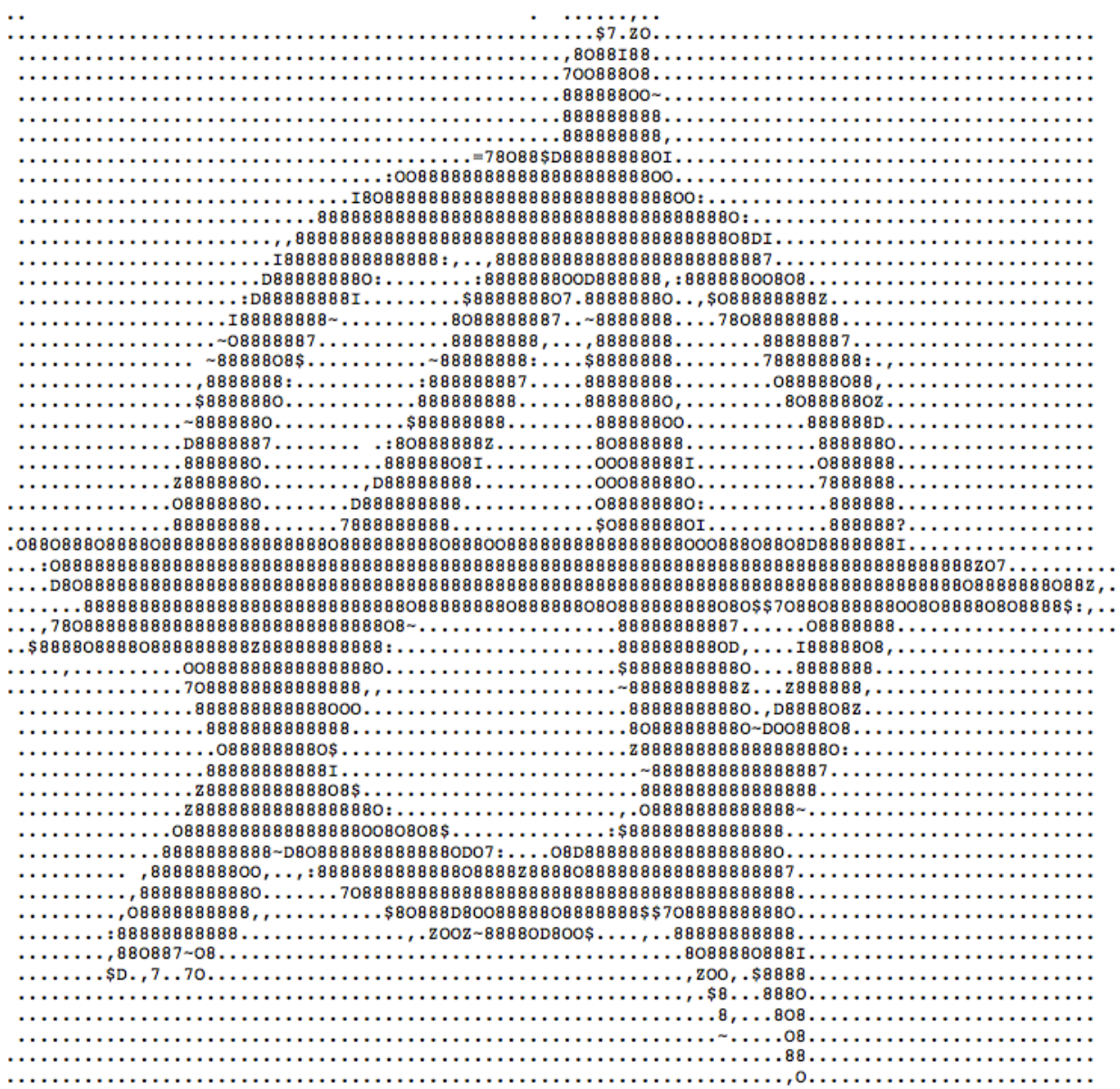
"We could always come back here in two years' time."

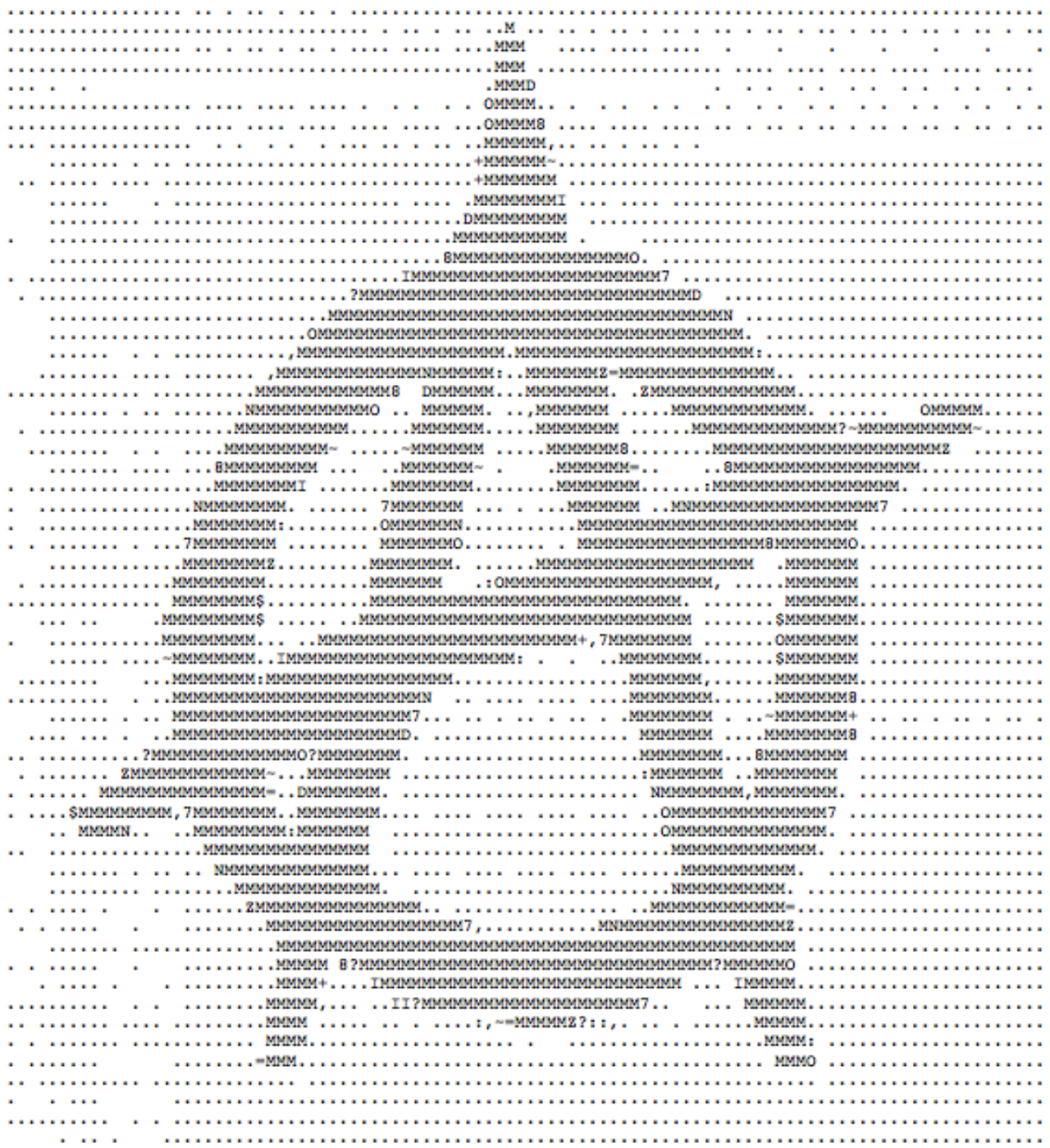
"It's a possibility." He replied.

We both knew we were never going to work there again.









14 ^

[14] Oh, the art! Oh, the protest! Look at me; I'm such a provocative writer! I spent four nights in front of a computer to create a dot-by-dot artwork! Praise me! Give me another Pulitzer! Pointless, useless, meaningless rubbish, if you ask me. Pointless, useless rubbish.

The Fabled City[15]

Harvey and I shouted slogans in Spanish,
like we'd actually wanted you there.
We're those somebodies, somewhere
Youngsters on Tramadol
always here
Tasting the latest season
of streets sounds
with more, you know – drugs.

Morning and passivity,
bad nightmares of blood stains
and IRA and religion
wrong wrong wrong
casual sex downtown, easy as a sneeze.

On a corner, a sunset at Christmas
my feet in the sand
I walked to where she lived.
Personal as many of the hidden
personal stories of the lower class,
never written and never sung.

Simple
more like a prayer

This city,
one hundred swallows,
a suspect,
I, as soon as planted
will follow it.

[15] As a systematic search for the evil in the world, Lanail Hudson's style could be legitimately attributed as a religious style, though, in a way, it would force us to see the entirety of Hudson's life as the definition of a universal religious literature, or, extensively, as mostly significant of an alleged mainstream western literature allegory. It is, instead, totally erroneous and potentially harmful. Emphasizing way over measure the factual data of tragic representations of this poem, as previously written by other critics who, the reader will forgive me, knew fuck all about the poet's life.

The Fabled City uses the strongest opposition possible, switching between the triviality of casual intercourse and the elevated themes (very close to Hudson's taste) of ritual Catholicism, portrayed as a the repetition of an immutable dramatic moment that challenges the reader in sharing the wait for something new that will unfortunately never come. It is a rational, delicate Aristotelian sequence, with a strong semantic action of the linearity of time and its irreversibility.

Fries with that

The dreams hopes and expectations
of a young actress in London.
Blinded by the lights of a million
stages she'll never get to walk on.
Dreams killed by Friday night drinks.

A nail
in the coffin of mediocrity
hammered down
by working double shift
the day of an audition.[16]

[16] Don't get me wrong. I'm grateful for everything Lanail did for me. I simply think he didn't care much about how important my work behind the scenes was. He believed he could get away with everything, and I was there to remind him that he wasn't a god. He was a *non compos mentis* human with a god complex, which is substantially different. He hated hearing it.

Lanail used to act like a deranged emotionless sociopath without any sort of moral compass. People didn't get him logically. His readers understood him on an emotional level that I probably couldn't, and I have no problems with openly admitting it.

Honestly though, he was the same waitress he talked about in *Fries with that*. He was an overrated writer, a mediocre philosopher and a not-more-than-decent poet. He was lucky he didn't have to work double shifts in a restaurant to pay his rent. And it's not like he could have kept a job around people, obviously. Lanail *needed me*; let's not dance around it. He needed moral guidance, and in retrospect I believe that was my "role". Whenever his *bohemian-inner-self* emerged we found ourselves dealing with hookers on acid, the German interview, and the Detroit incident.

He wanted to be understood and appreciated, but he hated when people actually interpreted his works correctly. When that happened, he felt naked.

"Once the people see that the Emperor is naked, they laugh, Leroy. They *laugh*." He used to say it all the time when talking about politicians. I believe that he felt that way about his books, too.

Did Lanail help my writing career? Yes, he did. And no, he didn't. He did boost the process, but I'm sure I would have gotten there eventually.

untitled/2

You're leaving today.
I smile, nervous.

You're leaving today
like you don't even care,
like asking a robot.

I smile as you, slowly,
(a scene in slow motion)
leave.

I smile and cry and smile.[17]

[17] Lanail and I were at a charity event at the National Theatre. It was one of those boring buffet dinners in which we had to show up, get drunk, find the balance between eating as much as possible without seeming desperate, and usually give a short speech pretending we cared about breast cancer, or needy kids, or whatever.

Two girls approached us. One of them, the talkative one, was stunning. Blond hair, blue eyes. Tall. A fantastic body. Her friend, a step behind her, was the obvious side wing. A sweet, nice, good looking girl, unfortunately shadowed by the overwhelming shining beauty of the girl next to her.

"Mr. Hudson! We're big fans of your work!" The talkative one said.

"It's a pleasure meeting you." Lanail said, showing the *least-dirty-minded* smile he could.

"I'm Marie, and this is my friend Annie."

Surprisingly, Annie turned to me. "Mr. Meyers. I highly appreciated your prose poems in *Jesus was a Steam Punk fanatic*."

She took me by surprise. "I didn't even think anyone would read my work. Let alone appreciate it."

"Oh, I did. I love how your incursions into reality drift suddenly into more abstract, post humanistic scenarios. I was very moved by *Electronic Campfires*. I honestly *love* your work, Mr. Meyers."

"Please. Call me Leroy."

Marie interrupted us.

"So, we're massive fans of your work. I have read *The Night of the Servant* four times, and I bought extra copies to give out to people - "

"That's very flattering." Lanail said.

" – and Annie knows all of your work by heart, Mr. Meyers."

"Leroy." I replied.

"We would like to give you a blowjob as a token of our gratitude."

Marie had just dropped on the table an offer I would have never had dreamed likely. I thought this kind of thing only happened in porn movies.

"Wha-?" I finally asked.

"Annie and I would like to show you our gratitude in a memorable way."

I looked at Annie. She nodded. I looked at Lanail to catch his reaction. Forty-five seconds later Annie and I walked in the Ladies, while Lanail and Marie walked into the gents.
Lanail and Marie got engaged three weeks later.

6,430 words